BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha, Australia Ltd

Donations in Kind Guideline

Objective

The purpose of this guideline is to provide a clear and consistent process for receiving, managing, and utilising donations in kind such as groceries, fruits, vegetables, grains, and other essential items. These donations will support large events while ensuring accountability, transparency, and effective planning.

Dedicated Lead

- Each center to appoint a dedicated Lead responsible for managing donations in kind.
- Responsibilities include:
    - Coordinating with donors
    - Maintaining on-going relationships with donors including inviting donors to mandir's event and acknowledgment of their support in the event.
    - Approach new donors
    - Maintaining accurate records of donations received
    - Ensuring Pickups and deliveries of items
    - Liaising with National Fundraising and local kitchen team for planning and reporting

Donor Database

- Each Centre should maintain a Database of Potential Donors for regular and one-time contributions.
- Database should include:
    - Donor name and contact details
    - Type of items previously donated
    - Frequency of donations
    - Preferred mode of contact

- Update the database regularly to track donor engagement and maintain relationships.

Yearly Approach Planning

- Each Centre should **develop a plan** for approaching donors for Diwali.
- Planning to include:
  - **Timeline** for outreach to donors
  - **Expected items and quantities** needed for each event
  - **Volunteer support** for collection, storage, and distribution
  - **Follow-up and acknowledgment** to donors

Guidelines for Receiving Donations

- Accept only items that are **safe and suitable** for the intended purpose.
- Check **expiry dates** and **quality** before acceptance.
- Maintain a **record of each donation** including:
  - Donor details
  - Item description and quantity
  - Date received

Pick-up and/or Delivery

- Coordinate with donors and arrange a pickup / delivery of the donated items.
- Liaise with the local kitchen lead to communicate the delivery schedule, ensuring proper arrangements are made for the storage of donated items.

Acknowledgment and Record

- Send **thank-you notes** to donors for their contributions.
- Record donations including donor, items and quantity donated.